

Okara — Deep Research Report

Prepared for: Chief Executive Officer and Président

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1. Company at a glance

Okara is a SAS at 67 rue de Luxembourg, Euralille, Lille, SIREN 933 593 493, incorporated on 17 September 2024 and registered at the RCS Lille Métropole in October 2024 under NAF code 6202A, consulting in information systems and software, within the Syntec collective agreement. Its corporate object covers consulting, audit, engineering, technical assistance, project management, the provision of experts and consultants whether salaried or not, recruitment, selection and portage of qualified personnel, and software design and development.

Two registry facts define what this company actually is. Okara was not incorporated as Okara: it was NEWPALLUR 3 SAS, a holding-classified entity registered at 64 boulevard de Cambrai in Roubaix, whose président was PALLUR SAS, a Roubaix holding company that also presides over NEWPALLUR 5, 6 and 7. By a shareholder decision dated 27 June 2025, PALLUR resigned as président, Pierre Buchsenschutz was appointed in its place, the corporate object was rewritten into its current IT-services form, and the registered office moved to Lille. This is a shelf company activated for a purpose, not a start-up founded by entrepreneurs, and 27 June 2025 is the operational start date.

The link to the Mulliez sphere runs through Buchsenschutz. He has been an administrateur of ELO, Auchan's holding company, since June 2024, and is gérant et associé commandité of ACANTHE, VALOREST, SOLIANCE, CIMOFAT and MARMEBUX — the five sociétés en commandite par actions through which the Mulliez family holds its stakes. He previously represented Auchan Retail France, Auchan Retail International and Kiabi Europe. Okara's shareholder of record is not publicly documented; registry platforms gate the beneficial-ownership list behind payment.

Christophe Debray succeeded Buchsenschutz as président, with the change published in the Bodacc in February 2026. His LinkedIn headline reads "Leader Okara — le collectif où les players bossent à leurs conditions". His background is recruitment leadership at scale rather than corporate IT: his own profile describes running the full recruitment activity — headhunting, RPO and consulting — for a business of roughly a thousand staff and €80 million of revenue, managing a team of 150 across fourteen countries, having previously managed up to 500. He also holds mandates at ALCES-RH and previously at ITALENT, a recruitment company he liquidated in 2012.

Scale is small and the published numbers conflict. The FY2024 accounts, filed in July 2025, show zero revenue and a net loss of €1,637 over a four-month first period; no FY2025 accounts had been filed by late August 2026. The government business register records no employees. Against that, an expired advert stated that seventeen people had joined — six in the core support team, six on permanent contracts and five freelance. Registered capital is €20,000 variable in the registry against €500,000 in the company's own legal notices of March 2026, unreconciled, though a variable-capital clause may explain the gap.

The business is a talent collective offering three switchable engagement modes — permanent employment, freelance and portage salarial — across six domains: integration and interoperability, development and digital innovation, cloud and infrastructure, cybersecurity and compliance, data and business intelligence, and IT support. The site scopes the addressable market as more than a hundred companies, more than 70,000 employees, around fifty countries and one common ground.

A second business line appears only in the job adverts. Okara is simultaneously building internal delivery capability and an internal recruitment agency: it has advertised a Tech Lead to build its first project squad and structure internal service centres, a Bid Manager at €80,000, a Senior Data Engineer and an AI Engineer; and a recruitment consultant advert describes a quartet of recruiters already in place looking for a fifth, covering IT and support functions, with a mandate to co-build the recruitment agency offer. Client work described in anonymised adverts is large-scale international retail IT: a Workday rollout with change management across 24 countries, an Oracle ERP Cloud finance transformation at €450–550 a day, AI-governance data work on Collibra, GCP, Looker Studio and dbt, marketplace and product-data work, and e-invoicing business analysis. Seventeen live adverts on a single board, all in Lille, spanned freelance day rates of €350–600 clustering at €380–450, and permanent developer salaries of €33,000–50,000. No client is named anywhere in Okara's material.

Questions to ask on the day:

- Who owns Okara's shares, and does the mandate from that shareholder say supply capacity to the network, or build a business that stands on its own commercial legs?
- What is the real headcount split today across core team, permanent consultants and freelancers, and the target twelve months out?
- Is the project-squad and internal-service-centre line a second business alongside individual placement, or where the whole company is heading?

2. Strategic direction

Okara's public positioning is written for talent, not for clients. The core sentence on its site is that Okara connects IT experts in data, cloud, cyber and development with the companies of the AFM. The manifesto language is that the codes have changed and Okara opens new ground for people who want to work differently, with more freedom, transparency and impact. Section headings run in the second person and in gaming register — enter the game, choose your status, you know your pay and ours too.

Four commitments are explicit: free choice of status, with nothing fixed; published pay, including salary grids, day rates and bonus structure, with no hidden margin; community, through thematic groups, an annual meetup and mentoring; and profit-sharing. The site carries a named testimonial

from a salaried cyber-security expert framing the appeal as skills development in service of AFM companies of any size.

The relationship to the AFM is described differently by audience, and the ladder matters. Recruitment copy is most explicit, calling Okara a young agile structure born in the heart of the Mulliez ecosystem whose mission is to become the indispensable strategic partner for recruiting and supplying experts. Okara's own site says only that it connects experts with AFM companies and never expands the acronym; its legal pages mention neither the AFM nor Mulliez nor any parent. Generic job boards get no network mention at all.

The AFM side does publish strategy, and it defines Okara's operating constraint. Barthélemy Guislain, président du conseil de gérance of the AFM, told the Assemblée nationale's commission d'enquête on 7 May 2025 that the AFM is not a group in the legal sense of the term and that the companies in which it holds majority interests have strong autonomy. He gave figures of 130 companies, more than 80 countries, more than 620,000 employees worldwide and nearly 175,000 in France, with more than 85% of employees holding shares.

That sentence is the strategic frame. A network of legally autonomous companies has no group procurement, no group vendor file and no obligation on anyone to buy internally. Pooled need is therefore a thesis Okara must sell company by company, not a channel it inherits. Okara's own scoping — around a hundred companies and 70,000 people — sits well below the AFM's stated size, which reads as Okara scoping the part of the network it believes it can actually reach.

Questions to ask on the day:

- When you say needs can be pooled, which are genuinely pooled today and which are still one conversation per company?
- The published-margin promise is unusual. What has it cost you in negotiations, and would you do it again?
- Given the AFM is not a group, who inside the network is accountable for Okara succeeding?

3. Industry forces

Demand is flat and the recovery keeps being revised down. Numeum cut its 2026 French digital market forecast from 4.3% in December 2025 to 3.0% in its July 2026 observatory with Xerfi, after 1.8% growth in 2025. Within that, the split is stark: software publishers and platforms grow 6.2% to €30.9 billion, driven by SaaS at 8.3% and cloud at 12.2%, while IT services firms manage 1% to €34.6 billion and technology consulting 0.2% to €7.7 billion. Numeum's new president, Mehdi Houas, framed the return of growth in services as encouraging but insufficient if buyers keep delaying. Client hesitancy is measured: 39% of CIOs said geopolitical uncertainty affected their digital investment decisions, of whom 57% deferred projects and 39% lengthened decision cycles.

The decline in 2025 was concentrated in services firms above 1,500 employees.

Employment has been falling for two years. Sector headcount dropped 1.8% between 2023 and 2025, the second consecutive annual fall, driven mainly by firms cutting recruitment rather than cutting staff. A third of services firms reduced graduate hiring in the first half of 2026 while redeploying skills toward higher-value activity.

Talent has polarised rather than loosened. Cyber, cloud, data and AI engineering remain scarce while juniors, generic development and routine maintenance are in surplus. Low turnover compounds it: people are staying put, which makes them harder to recruit away, and demand is concentrating on the newest skills rather than the broad middle.

Generative AI is attacking the billing unit and the industry says so openly. Numeum measures material productivity gains from AI in services delivery and has put the question directly at its own forum: if AI halves development time, what happens to time-and-materials billing? The direction of travel it points to is contractual recomposition toward capacity, outcome and shared-gain pricing. The asymmetry is worth noting — no named French or European IT services chief executive is on record saying AI is cutting their billable hours; the only quantified claims come from industry survey data.

The freelance channel is growing and is disproportionately an IT channel. The portage salarial branch report records tens of thousands of consultants and around €2 billion of sector revenue, with IT services named by roughly three-quarters of portage firms as their leading domain. The structural argument behind the shift is speed and cost: freelance onboarding in days against months for a services framework. On the supplier side, advisers argue that freelance-first models run materially higher EBITDA than hybrids precisely because they remove bench risk — an argument made by interested parties, but one Okara's own model has to answer.

Questions to ask on the day:

- Are your rates set by market benchmarks or by what internal clients have budgeted, and what happens when the two diverge?
- If freelance-first models really run better margins than hybrids, why keep a permanent population at all?
- If a mission that took forty days now takes twenty, who captures that — you, the consultant, or the client?

4. Regulatory and compliance frame

The structural issue for an intra-group supplier is a legal pincer, and it is the defining compliance problem of this model.

French labour law prohibits any profit-making operation whose exclusive object is the lending of labour, under article L8241-1 of the Code du travail, and marchandage under L8231-1 covers profit-making labour supply that harms the employee or evades legal or collective provisions. Both carry two years' imprisonment and a €30,000 fine, rising to five years and €75,000 in aggravating circumstances, plus a two-to-ten-year ban on subcontracting labour. The lawful-service defence rests on three cumulative tests confirmed by the Cour de cassation's social chamber in December 2019: the consultant brings specific technical expertise the client does not possess, the mission is precisely defined, and the original employer retains direction, control and disciplinary power. On those grounds a ten-year on-site assignment survived challenge. The negative indicia are equally settled: tasks identical to the client's own with no specificity, the client directing the personnel, and pure hourly billing with no distinct service content.

The other jaw is tax. The 2024 finance act cut the transfer-pricing documentation threshold from €400 million to €150 million, and it reaches any French entity belonging to a group in which any company meets that threshold. The minimum penalty for failing to produce documentation rose to €50,000, and from FY2024 the documentation is opposable — divergence between documented policy and actual results is presumed to be an indirect transfer of profits. Separately, intra-group service fees are the classic ground for an *acte anormal de gestion* challenge, defensible only where the services are purely technical and distinct from management functions, documented contemporaneously and evidenced as actually rendered.

The two regimes pull in opposite directions. Transfer pricing requires a defensible arm's-length margin on intra-group services. The L8241-2 exemption for non-profit labour lending applies only where the invoice is limited to wages, charges and expenses, with no margin. So Okara must charge a margin, and the only thing that makes a margin lawful under L8241-1 is demonstrable technical specificity plus its own retained direction of the work. The same evidence defends both positions. This is not theoretical: URSSAF's 2025 results show over €1.5 billion of undeclared-work recoveries across several thousand targeted controls at a high hit rate, with financial-solidarity actions rising sharply — the mechanism by which a large client gets billed for its supplier's failures.

Employer-side obligations bite immediately. The employer must keep paying and bears an obligation to provide work during *intercontrat*; prolonged *intercontrat* has supported damages for moral prejudice and, at four months, judicial termination at the employer's fault. Mission mobility cannot be assumed from the collective agreement, because Syntec article 61 defines no geographic zone and is therefore not a valid mobility clause; mobility must sit in each individual contract. On freelancers, article L8221-6 presumes non-salaried status for registered businesses, rebuttable only by a permanent relationship of subordination.

Vigilance runs both ways. For any contract at or above €5,000 excluding tax, article L8222-1 requires the client to collect an URSSAF *attestation de vigilance* less than six months old, proof of registration and the list of foreign workers, every six months, with joint and several liability under L8222-2. Okara's clients will demand this pack from Okara; Okara owes the identical duty to every

freelancer and subcontractor above the same threshold.

On the digital rules, the position is more comfortable than it looks, and it has moved since the spring. France has still not transposed NIS2: the loi Résilience was adopted by the Senate in March 2025 and amended in National Assembly committee in September 2025, but no transposition law had been promulgated by August 2026, and on 8 July 2026 the European Commission referred France to the Court of Justice seeking a lump sum and daily penalties until full transposition is notified. ANSSI's Référentiel Cyber France, published 17 March 2026, remains a non-binding working document tied to the draft legislation. Managed service providers sit in the directive's scope by sector, but the size test keeps a company of Okara's dimensions out of direct scope. The binding obligation is therefore contractual rather than regulatory: article 21(2)(d) requires in-scope clients to secure relations with direct suppliers, which arrives as security questionnaires, certification evidence, incident-notification clauses, audit rights and sub-supplier disclosure — with no grace period tied to French transposition. On GDPR, exposure concentrates in personnel controls under articles 28 and 32, because those are the acts a supplier controls when the infrastructure belongs to the client.

The AI Act timetable also moved. The Digital Omnibus on AI, Regulation (EU) 2026/1744, was published on 24 July 2026 and entered into force on 27 July, deferring high-risk obligations for stand-alone Annex III systems to 2 December 2027 and for AI embedded in regulated Annex I products to 2 August 2028, while adding new prohibited practices. Article 50 transparency obligations still applied from 2 August 2026, with a four-month transition to 2 December 2026 for machine-readable marking on generative systems already on the market. Recruitment and employment systems sit squarely in Annex III, so a company building AI into candidate matching gets runway rather than relief.

One piece of good news is easy to miss. The CSRD Omnibus, Directive (EU) 2026/470, in force since 18 March 2026, raised the reporting threshold to more than 1,000 employees and more than €450 million net turnover, and created a value-chain cap: undertakings not exceeding 1,000 employees on average cannot be required to provide information beyond the Commission's voluntary standards, have a statutory right to decline, and contrary contractual clauses are not binding, with requesters obliged to notify them of what exceeds the standard and of that right. Okara can answer ESG questionnaires at voluntary-standard level and decline the rest. Whether procurement departments respect that is a commercial question, not a legal one. Separately, France's duty of vigilance law puts Okara inside its large clients' published vigilance plans as an established supplier, which is the route by which supplier codes, audit clauses and social-compliance attestations arrive.

Questions to ask on the day:

- What evidence do you keep, per mission, that Okara directs the work and brings expertise the client does not have?

- Who owns your transfer-pricing file, and has anyone reconciled the margin it requires with the labour-law position?
- How many separate client vendor-onboarding and security packs are you maintaining, and how often does each need refreshing?

5. The chief executive's world at Okara

A chief executive in this business is held to a small and unforgiving set of numbers, and the international benchmark series says the industry has been losing on them. Service Performance Insight's Professional Services Maturity Benchmark, covering several hundred firms and over 150,000 consultants, reported billable utilisation of 68.9%, revenue per consultant of \$199,000, project margin of 35.9% and EBITDA of 9.8% in its 2025 edition — down from 15.4% in 2023, a historic low. The 2026 edition is reported to show utilisation falling further to 66.4% with EBITDA roughly flat at 9.9%. Read together, firms defended rates and cut bench rather than the reverse, and profitability still halved.

In France the equivalents are the intercontrat rate and utilisation, and no independent French body publishes audited benchmarks for either — which is itself a finding. The practitioner numbers in circulation come from software vendors selling to services firms, so they are interested sources, but they converge: an optimal intercontrat band in the mid single digits, above 15% considered critical, bench cost of several thousand euros per consultant per year, and a well-run firm at 25–30% gross margin. On that arithmetic one point of occupancy is worth more than several points of day rate, which is why occupancy rather than rate is what a président is actually judged on. Speed is the other axis: the firms that place fastest are consistently those with a formal redeployment process rather than an ad hoc one.

Where the time goes is well documented for chief executives generally and poorly cushioned at this company size. The Harvard study tracking chief executives in fifteen-minute increments found 62.5-hour weeks, around 72% of working time in meetings, and roughly 43% of time spent on the executive's own agenda against 36% reactive. The larger international sample including France found around 50 hours a week with about 70% in direct interaction. At Okara's size the administrative load lands personally: French small and medium businesses spend around 7.7% of working time on administration, at the high end internationally, and founder surveys in growth mode put well over a third of the week on administration led by expenses, scheduling, invoicing, data entry and chasing payment. A founder-président of a firm this size carries the meeting load without the support structure, and what is 11% unavoidable routine for a large-cap chief executive becomes the whole compliance stack on one desk.

The recurring frustrations in this specific business are measured. Matching is the largest single time sink — recruiters spend roughly fifteen hours a week on search and match, and industry

research names candidate search as by far the most time-consuming part of the day. Administration per vacancy has been measured at around eighteen hours, of which several go to reviewing applications, processing post-interview notes and scheduling, with a majority of recruiters naming manual data entry as a barrier. Scattered data is the named blocker to fixing it, with data limitations cited as the single biggest barrier to using AI in recruitment. Client procurement is slow and committee-heavy, with double-digit stakeholder counts on larger contracts and enterprise sales cycles running close to a year. And responsiveness costs talent directly: three-quarters of candidates report stopping work with a recruiter because the process took too long or communication was insufficient, while those told about the next assignment before the current one ends show substantially higher loyalty.

The French personal exposure is real. A président of a SAS is the legal representative and personally exposed on civil, criminal and insolvency axes, including liability for company debts where a management fault contributed to insufficiency of assets, and personal tax liability in defined circumstances. The calendar is monthly, with payroll declarations due mid-month and event declarations within days, penalties assessed per employee per month. Cash is structurally tight: French payment delays average around fourteen days beyond terms, with companies above a thousand employees exceeding twenty days, and fewer than half paying on time. Payroll leaves monthly while large-client cash arrives on a two-month lag, so for a company with no filed trading history the binding constraint is working-capital cover rather than investment finance.

Questions to ask on the day:

- What number do you look at first on a Monday morning?
- How much of your week goes on things a fifth recruiter or an office manager could take?
- When a mission ends, how far in advance do you know, and who tells whom?

6. Peer signals

Schwarz Digits is the clearest precedent for a captive technology unit becoming a vendor. Created as the Schwarz Group's fifth division in September 2023, bundling STACKIT, XM Cyber and the group's IT and data operations, it has grown past €2 billion in annual revenue and now sells to named third parties outside the group, alongside major data-centre investment and stated hyperscaler ambitions. It is adjacent rather than comparable, but it is the full arc: internal-only, then branded division, then external revenue, then own infrastructure.

Decathlon Digital is the in-house competitor for the same Lille technologists. Established as a distinct technology brand in 2020, it publishes externally as an employer brand and organises around disciplines — data science and engineering, cybersecurity, software engineering, infrastructure and operations, digital design, product management — that map almost one for one

onto Okara's six domains. That makes it simultaneously one of the largest potential clients in the network and the strongest competitor for the same candidates.

Adeo shows an AFM-network company insourcing platform capability rather than buying it. In December 2025 it detailed an internally built platform to govern third-party large language models across its brands, covering governance, cost management, security, load balancing and traceability, and reported product-attribute coverage rising sharply as a result. Its group technology leadership has publicly defended a heavily weighted build-over-buy position on the grounds that differentiation cannot be bought off the shelf. No separately branded Adeo technology entity comparable to Decathlon Digital or Schwarz Digits exists publicly.

Auchan is the restructuring backdrop, in Okara's own city. Its November 2024 plan covered close to 2,400 posts, including 784 from merging support structures — Auchan Retail International, the international procurement organisation and Auchan France Support — 224 from closing three e-commerce warehouses, and 1,380 in retail operations, and drew a public government response. On the financial side, S&P affirmed ELO at BB– with a negative outlook in July 2025, projecting leverage around 5.3x in 2025 against a previous forecast of 4.7x, and noting that EBITDAR coverage had fallen to 1.3x in 2024 from 2.5x in 2023 and 3.5x in 2022, a level it described as very weak for the rating. Head-office headcount reduction alongside continuing IT ambition is exactly the condition that creates demand for flexible external capacity, and exactly the condition that caps what can be paid for it.

Comet is the closest model analogue in the French market. In March 2025 it raised €10 million and installed a new chief executive with a declared strategy of moving beyond freelance matching into AI and cybersecurity services. A marketplace concluding that matching alone is not defensible, and adding the same practices Okara declares, is direct evidence that Okara's differentiation is contested. Freelance.com is the audited thermometer and it turned down: its FY2025 results published in April 2026 showed revenue essentially flat at just over €1 billion but organic decline, with France down 6% organically and EBITDA down 12%, and a stated prudent view of 2026.

Questions to ask on the day:

- Is Decathlon Digital a client, a competitor for candidates, or both, and does that ambiguity get in the way?
- Schwarz Digits sells outside its group. Is external revenue on your horizon or explicitly off the table?
- When two network companies pay different rates for the same profile, how do you hold your published grid together?

7. Friction map

Demand arrives as many small, differently shaped requests from around a hundred legally autonomous companies, with no group procurement route to any of them, and no obligation on any of them to say what they are planning.

There is no single place that says who is free next month, because availability is split across permanent, freelance and portage populations with different notice mechanics. Matching a mission brief to that pool is manual reading, and it is the largest measured consumer of recruiter time.

Every placement is effectively packaged twice, once for the salaried path and once for the freelance path, for the same piece of client work. The published-margin promise then means every rate has to be defensible in public, against grids, barometers and the person sitting opposite — while rates are capped by internal client budgets and Syntec minima rise underneath them.

The law obliges the company to keep paying and to find work during intercontrat, but the client controls when missions start. Mission end dates are chased individually, and renewal news usually arrives late enough that redeployment is reactive rather than planned.

Each client entity runs its own vendor onboarding, so the same attestations, security answers and ESG responses are assembled again for each, then refreshed every six months. Underneath that, the margin required for transfer pricing is the same margin that must be justified as technical specificity under labour law, and the evidence for both is assembled mission by mission.

Payroll leaves monthly while large-client cash arrives on a two-month lag, so cash forecasting is a weekly exercise on incomplete information. And AI is compressing the day-rate unit at the exact moment the company is standardising on it as its pricing basis.

Questions to ask on the day:

- Which of these would you put first, and which would you strike out as not your problem?
- Which did you expect when you started, and which one surprised you?

Challenge cards

Card 1 of 2

Title: Finding the work before the brief

The challenge: Okara is meant to be the pooled IT talent capability for around a hundred companies, but there is no list anywhere of what those companies are about to need. A project surfaces when someone happens to mention it, or when a formal brief has already landed somewhere else and it is too late to shape it. Every week the picture of network demand is pieced

together from conversations, and it is knowingly incomplete.

Who feels it: The chief executive first, because pipeline is his number. Then the recruiters, sourcing against demand nobody has confirmed; then the consultants, whose next mission depends on a signal that arrives late; then the client-side IT managers who go outside for capacity that already existed inside the network.

Why it persists: The AFM's president told the Assemblée nationale that the AFM is not a group in the legal sense and that its companies have strong autonomy, and subsidiarity is a stated organising principle. There is therefore no group procurement, no shared demand register and no obligation on any company to disclose what it is planning. Okara's own site scopes the reachable network at well below the AFM's stated size, which suggests this is already understood.

What solved looks like: On Monday the chief executive can see what is coming across the companies he serves while it is still an intention rather than a tender, and can tell his recruiters what to look for six weeks out. Consultants finishing a mission hear about the next one before the current one ends rather than after.

Evidence base: Guislain's statement to the commission d'enquête on 7 May 2025 and his figures of 130 companies and more than 620,000 employees; the AFM's stated subsidiarity principle; the gap between Okara's scoping of around a hundred companies and 70,000 people and the AFM's own figures; enterprise sales cycles close to a year with double-digit stakeholder counts; and recruitment research showing three-quarters of candidates abandoning a recruiter over slow process or poor communication, against substantially higher loyalty where the next assignment is known before the current one ends.

Open question: When a company in the network decides it needs a data engineer, how does Okara find out today, and how long after the decision?

Card 2 of 2

Title: Proving the same things, again

The challenge: Every company Okara sells into runs its own vendor onboarding, and each wants broadly the same things in its own format: vigilance attestations, insurance, security answers, data-protection annexes, ESG questionnaires, evidence of who directs the work. The same questions get answered for the tenth buyer, then the attestations expire and they get answered again. None of it wins a mission; all of it can stop one starting.

Who feels it: The chief executive, because on a team this size the compliance file is his desk. The recruiters and core support team, who assemble packs instead of talking to people. The consultant, whose start date slips while a document is chased. And the client's own procurement and security functions, re-verifying a supplier their sister company already cleared.

Why it persists: The obligations are real and they are per entity, not per network. Article L8222-1 requires each client to collect an attestation de vigilance every six months for any contract above €5,000. NIS2's article 21(2)(d) makes in-scope clients secure their own direct suppliers, and that flows through contracts regardless of France's transposition delay. Each client's vigilance plan reaches its established suppliers separately. Because the companies are legally autonomous, nothing lets one company's clearance count for another, so the work scales with the number of buyers rather than the volume of business.

What solved looks like: A first mission at a company Okara has never billed before starts in days rather than weeks, because the evidence already exists in a form the buyer accepts and nobody rebuilds it. The six-monthly refresh happens without anyone noticing.

Evidence base: Articles L8222-1 and L8222-2 with the €5,000 threshold, six-monthly attestations and joint and several liability; NIS2 article 21(2)(d) supplier-security flow-down, with France still untransposed as of August 2026 and referred to the Court of Justice on 8 July 2026; GDPR articles 28 and 32; the CSRD value-chain cap and statutory right to decline under Directive (EU) 2026/470; measured recruitment administration of roughly eighteen hours per vacancy with manual data entry named as the leading barrier; and the overlap between the transfer-pricing margin file and the labour-law technical-specificity evidence.

Open question: How many separate client onboarding files does Okara maintain today, and who refreshes them when they expire?

Where this document is thin

- There is no press coverage of Okara anywhere. Searches across the main French national, regional and technology titles return nothing. This is treated as a finding, not a gap.
- Okara's shareholder of record is not public. The registry shows PALLUR SAS incorporated the entity; it does not show who holds the shares today or whether any AFM entity does.
- No Okara client is ever named. Every advert anonymises. The Workday and Oracle Finance descriptions point somewhere, but no source names it.
- Okara's real headcount, FY2025 revenue and margin are unknown. No FY2025 accounts had been filed as of late August 2026, and the seventeen-people figure rests on a single expired advert.
- Registered capital is stated as €20,000 in the registry and €500,000 in the company's own legal notices, unreconciled.
- Christophe Debray's employer names and tenures before Okara are not independently verifiable; the scale of his prior recruitment leadership comes from his own profile.

- Decathlon Digital's technology headcount is reported very differently across sources, ranging from around 1,500 to several thousand depending on whether the figure counts the legal entity or the group's technology community.
- No AFM-wide pooled IT or shared-services organisation is documented other than Valiuz, the shared data and CRM alliance covering Auchan, Boulanger, Kiabi, Leroy Merlin, Norauto and others but notably not Decathlon. The AFM's own site is silent on shared IT, and that absence is itself a finding.
- No consolidated AFM revenue figure is published anywhere, consistent with the AFM's position that it is not a group, and the available scale figures mutually contradict.
- No French body publishes an average intercontrat rate or a services billing-rate index; the utilisation and margin targets in circulation come from software vendors selling to services firms.
- No named French or European IT services chief executive is on record saying AI is cutting their billable hours; only survey data quantifies it.